

The Attogram Foundation — Formal Summary & Self-Audit

Public issue draft, awareness-horizon. Two parts by design: the formalized statement first, then the adversarial critique of that statement in the same issue. Publishing the claim and the audit of the claim together is the ethos — receipts include the receipts against yourself.

PART ONE — Formal Summary

What this is

A **family-based, AI-adjunctive swarm**: a small group of real humans (n=20) using consumer AI as an adjunct for high-velocity creation, curation, and analysis of a documented corpus.

The entity

The Attogram Foundation — an Amsterdam nonprofit (Dutch **Stichting**), structured on the blueprint of the **Blender Foundation**: a nonprofit steward of open

output, governed independently, funded toward a public mission.

The three pillars (the intellectual foundation)

1. **Post-Traumatic Growth (PTG)** — Tedeschi & Calhoun's framework: transformation through the struggle to re-narrate a shattered assumptive world. *(Backed by a full literature review in the corpus, including the field's own unresolved veridical-vs-illusory measurement debate.)*
2. **Life-blogging / lifelogging** — externalized, timestamped documentation of lived experience, from Bush's Memex through MyLifeBits and SenseCam. *(Backed; connection to PTG documented.)*
3. **2026 Consumer AI** — the first individually-accessible processing layer able to turn a raw life-record into deliberate rumination; the missing third leg that makes the first two operational now. *(Backed by the three-leg study.)*

The three rules (the culture)

1. **You must have fun.** (Human Rule Zero.)
2. **Pop culture is required.**
3. **Sesame Street is the teacher.**

Current state (honest)

- **Budget:** €500/month (self-funded).
 - **Humans:** n=20 (meat-space participants; opt-in personas).
 - **Method:** high-velocity artifact creation, curation, analysis; expand-compress-iterate; human merge-review as the containment gate.
 - **Receipts:** *academic* receipts produced (sourced, audit-oriented studies). *Institutional* receipts still gated (see Part Two).
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PART TWO — Self-Audit (the adversarial critique)

Written to be harder on the summary than a friendly reader would be, because a claim published without its own critique is marketing, not a receipt.

1. "We have the receipts" — split the ledger

The single most important correction. There are **two kinds of receipt** and the summary risks collapsing them:

- **Academic receipts: done.** The pillars now stand on real, sourced documents that were written to survive an adversarial read. This is a genuine rung climbed today.

- **Institutional receipts: NOT done.** The things that actually move the Foundation from ~5/100 toward real remain outstanding: a **KvK registration number**, **one external euro** (money from someone who is not Node 0), and a **signed independent-officer commitment** (officers empowered to hire and fire the founder). None exist yet.

The **€500/month is fuel, not a receipt** — it is the founder's own money and proves the project's existence only to the founder. An auditor counts the KvK number, the external euro, and the signed officer. Until those exist, the honest status is *"academic receipts done; institutional receipts gated."*

2. Pillars are proven; rules are culture — don't show the wrong one to the wrong audience

The **pillars** are load-bearing intellectual claims with backing. The **rules** are culture. "Sesame Street is the teacher" is true to the corpus and delightful in the workshop — and reads as *unserious* to a Stichting notary or a Horizon Europe / NLnet reviewer. Blender does not put its cultural equivalent in its KvK filing. Keep the two layers **separable**: pillars to funders and officers, rules to the swarm. Losing that separation is how a fundable project gets dismissed as a hobby.

3. The pillars' own foundation is contested – and that's the opening, if handled honestly

PTG's standard instrument (the PTGI) correlates only weakly with *actual* measured change (Frazier 2009; Jayawickreme). If the Foundation leans on PTG as settled science, it inherits that weakness. The honest and stronger move is to use the lifelog+AI stack to **attack** the measurement problem, not to assume PTG is proven. Claiming more certainty than the field has is the fastest way to fail an expert audit.

4. The third pillar makes the risks sharper, not softer

2026 AI as processor is the novel leg – and it worsens every failure mode: **sycophancy** manufacturing illusory growth (the Flattery Ratchet), **total-recall** feeding intrusive rumination toward re-traumatization, and "**who holds the processor**" flipping the whole instrument from diary to surveillance. The Foundation's anti-sycophancy / sovereign-ownership / human-gate commitments are therefore **not features but preconditions**. A version of the pillar that omits this is snake oil.

5. "Family-based" + n=20 + public repo + minors = the consent gate is load-bearing

Opt-in personas and self-authored forks are healthy. But the swarm includes **minors** (Kibbitz channel), the repo is **public**, and Zenodo is **permanent**. The right-to-erasure-vs-permanence tension lands on actual family members. Every self-persona needs explicit **consent + withdrawal**, and for minors the default must lean toward **less permanence**. This is the one place "move fast" is the wrong instinct.

6. Novelty is a working belief, not a proven claim

The PTG × lifelogging × AI conjunction *appears* under-occupied, but "we couldn't find prior work" is not proof. A priority claim needs a **systematic search** (PsycINFO, PubMed, Scopus, ACM) before it's asserted in writing. "AI + journaling" already exists as a category; the defensible novel seam is the narrower triple.

7. The Blender blueprint is smart but not free

Blender is a mature foundation with a shipped product, a global user base, and decades of receipts. Using its *structure* as a blueprint is sound. Implying **parity** with it is not — the Attogram Foundation is at ~5/100 on its own maturity ladder. Borrow the skeleton, don't borrow the credibility you haven't earned yet.

Bottom line

The structure is coherent, the pillars are genuinely backed as of today, and the culture is distinctive.

What remains is not intellectual — it's institutional:

KvK number, one external euro, one signed

independent officer. Those three boring artifacts, not another study and not another €500, are the next real rung. Everything above the line is ready to show a funder; everything below the line is why they'd say "come back when you're a registered Stichting with an independent board."

Publish both parts or neither. The self-audit is the receipt.